

Because there are so many versions of UNIX around from the early days of complex computing and operating systems, the industry calls the original version that BSD and all other ports came from, “Research UNIX”.

Fast Forward to 1992, and we find the husband and wife team of William and Lynne Jolitz, who rewrote a lot of the BSD code to replace the old AT&T code with code that could be made open source, as was the BSD way. They also re-wrote BSD to be usable on Intel’s 80386-based microprocessors, and called that 386BSD. Eventually, because of neglect and not enough updating done to 386BSD, a group of users forked 386BSD and came up with FreeBSD.

So stable and secure is FreeBSD, that a lot of other OSes borrow from it. In fact, MacOS by Apple had borrowed heavily from FreeBSD and NetBSD in order to build the OS that they’re very proud of now. Even the PlayStation 3 OS, as well as the PlayStation 4 OS, and even the Nintendo Switch OS have elements borrowed from it (legally of course!).

Today, FreeBSD accounts for over two thirds of all BSD-style operating systems installed in the world, and there are a lot of very stable internet servers that run off it. FreeBSD is also considered to be far more secure (or securable) than most other OSes out there, and is the preferred choice of the geekiest of server admins.

In this book we will show you the basics of not just FreeBSD, but also some general tips and tricks that will come in handy no matter what operating system you use.

For a change, we’re not just providing the content in this book, which is informative and should help you go from FreeBSD beginner to intermediate. We will also be putting the last four chapters of this book online, because we did not want to limit ourselves to the page count of this physical book. If you are reading this in the digital version of this Fast Track, you will see what we mean, as you will have access to them.

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